

Chapter 164-1 Final Extra

Three whole years had passed since the day Jiang Li cut her hair, resigned from her position as young sect master, left the immortal realm, and fled to the mortal world.

During these three years, she never again contacted any old friends from her past. Wholeheartedly disguising herself as a mortal to travel the mortal realm, only when she used her feet to measure those mountains, rivers, lakes, and seas did she truly feel the vastness of heaven and earth.

Wherever she went, she practiced medicine locally. The more people she treated, the more she could hear news from neighbors—things like the aunt from East Market remarrying, the young master from West Market eloping. After confirming there was no sign of Black Scales in a place, she would pack her bags, wrap her veil around her face, and continue being her traveling physician.

As the days went on, she became somewhat dazed, not knowing where she was. Even though she had always prided herself on being strong, facing a road that might never end, she also developed a faint melancholy.

After feeling melancholy, she would continue searching.

On the border of Qi State was a city called Anfeng, a commercial thoroughfare where travelers flowed endlessly. But the people here were of mixed quality, with bandits often mingling among the crowds to rob merchants.

Over time, another group of people emerged. These were refugees who had fled from all directions, most carrying some martial arts skills. The people of Anfeng called them blade mercenaries—they made a living protecting lives for money, licking blood off knife edges.

Rumor had it that among the blade mercenaries was a god-like existence who never failed in their missions. Merchants competed to pay for their services, calling this person "Anfeng's First Blade."

However, this person had a strange personality. They never accepted silver for their services, only looking at the merchants' backgrounds. Even if corrupt and fraudulent people brought ten thousand taels of gold, they wouldn't take the job. But if someone had a clean family background and was charitable, they could be hired with a single request.

Additionally, some people spread rumors that this person was ugly, with a pitch-black tattoo on their left face and a hideous appearance.

Jiang Li had been practicing medicine in Qi State for three months before hearing this news. This trip was specifically to find this person.

The moment she stepped into Anfeng city, she suddenly trembled all over, nearly unable to stand steady. Supporting herself against the city gate and feeling dizzy for a while, she finally heard the rude greeting from a burly man behind her.

"Got business? If not, get out of the way!"

Jiang Li didn't mind the man's rudeness. She just silently moved aside, wrapping her veil more tightly, and following a map drawn by a kind person, squeezed through the dusty streets into narrow alleys.

This was where the blade mercenaries gathered. There were many doorways, and the alleys were filled with drying weapons and straw mats. Many dark-skinned blade mercenaries sat waiting in front of doors, their gazes falling on her, sharp as knives.

Jiang Li didn't look at those blade mercenaries. The further she walked, the more her legs became weak and her head dizzy. Yet her constantly racing heart seemed to be foretelling something, making her quicken her pace instead.

After turning another narrow alley, there were even more blade mercenaries sitting by doorways, some still stained with blood. Seeing a woman enter, they all slowly stood up and gathered around her.

Jiang Li's vision suddenly darkened a bit. She thought to herself this was bad—she had been too hasty and should have found a place to rest first.

She reached back to pull out a silver needle, preparing to pierce an acupoint to keep herself alert. But at this moment, those blade mercenaries seemed to see something and immediately dispersed, the bloody smell that had surrounded her also fading.

Her hand holding the silver needle froze in place, because a pitch-black figure appeared behind the crowd. Their sleeves and trouser legs were wrapped with cloth strips, black fabric hung diagonally across their shoulder, and their waist was bound with bandages that outlined a supple waistline.

"Little black snake..." Jiang Li murmured as she walked forward two steps, then her knees went weak and she completely lost consciousness.

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When she opened her eyes again, she was lying in choking smoke, on a hard wooden bed. She suddenly sat up, turning over. Above her were unfinished ceiling beams, the brick walls gloomy, the room small and stifling.

Jiang Li was dazed for a while, then barefoot on the rough ground, she strode outside. Without looking, she hugged that person's waist from behind.

The person was cooking something. When suddenly embraced, their toes pushed forward slightly, but they didn't speak.

They just lightly twisted their waist, removing her tightly clinging hands, silently taking the pot down and carrying it to the courtyard.

Jiang Li looked at her empty hands, said nothing, and followed step by step to the door. The person placed the pot on a table built of stone bricks, glancing down at her bare feet.

"You're too tired. Drink this, then leave." Black Scales spoke, ladling the strangely colored contents of the pot for Jiang Li, never raising her face.

Jiang Li said nothing. She took the bowl and drank it down gulp by gulp. The bitter taste spread across her tongue. Black Scales instinctively reached into her bosom but found nothing there.

In the past when they studied medicine on the mountain, they would always taste each other's medicinal broths. Jiang Li feared bitterness, so Black Scales would always keep some malt candy in her bosom.

Back then, Black Scales wasn't called Black Scales either.

"What is this?" Jiang Li asked, looking at the murky medicinal broth.

"Snake gallbladder."

"..."

Black Scales said no more, getting up to return to the room. She took a palm fan to fan away the thick smoke, and Jiang Li followed her inside, standing behind her.

"Didn't I tell you to leave?" Black Scales spoke with barbs, cold as a block of ice. "Young master of the Jiang family, why suffer in this filthy place?"

"I came to find you." Jiang Li said gently.

"I'm not worthy." Black Scales said flatly, then walked around her back into the sunlight, crouching down to wash the pot.

Jiang Li pattered after her to the door. Wherever Black Scales went, she followed. Her jade-white feet walked across blood-stained brick ground, getting quite muddy.

Finally, Black Scales couldn't stand it anymore. She suddenly threw the pot in her hands away, went back to the room to get Jiang Li's shoes, and crouched in front of her, indicating she should lift her foot.

Jiang Li's eyes flowed with emotion. Finally, she looked down at the woman whose dark, seaweed-like hair was curled and scattered, her hair covering her smooth forehead.

Black Scales seemed very impatient, simply reaching out to lift her foot and forcibly putting the shoe on, using such force that she gripped the delicate white ankle, leaving several red marks.

"Leave quickly." Black Scales issued another eviction order. "If you don't leave soon, don't blame me for throwing you out."

"With my despicable body, I'm capable of anything." Black Scales said in a low voice.

Jiang Li's eyes reddened. She lowered her lashes, hummed in acknowledgment, slowly walked out the door, and closed it.

Black Scales stared blankly at the shabby wooden door, not knowing whether she felt relieved. Then she continued crouching down, slowly washing the pot. Even after washing, the pot still had many stains, but she didn't want to bother with it anymore. She casually threw it down and returned to the bed.